

Anwar TalentFlow

Software Development Assignment

Assignment Context

As part of the selection process for technology roles at Anwar Group of Industries, candidates are invited to design and develop a practical Talent Acquisition system based on a real business requirement.

The assignment is intended to assess your ability to:

- Understand business processes
- Simplify complex workflows
- Design user-friendly software
- Build secure and scalable architecture
- Prioritize an effective MVP
- Explain technical and product decisions clearly

We are not looking for the largest system. We are looking for a practical solution that employees would genuinely use.

1. Business Problem

Anwar Group's recruitment process currently involves ERF/RRF documents, Excel, email, WhatsApp, phone calls, paper assessments, interview forms, and manual follow-ups.

This creates several challenges:

- Candidate information is stored in multiple locations
- Recruitment ownership is not always visible
- Candidate status updates require repeated manual communication
- Interview feedback and approvals are often delayed
- Management lacks one reliable view of recruitment progress

The system should create a simple coordination layer around the existing process without trying to replace everything immediately.

2. Product Objective

Design the first version of **Anwar TalentFlow**, a low-friction Talent Acquisition Coordination System.

The system should ensure that:

1. Every application has one assigned recruiter.
 2. Every application has one current stage.
 3. Every active application has one visible next action, owner, and due date.
 4. Candidate messages are prepared consistently and approved before sending.
 5. Delays and pending actions are visible to responsible users and management.
-

3. Primary Users

- Talent Acquisition administrators
- Recruiters
- Department heads and hiring managers
- Interview panel members
- HR leadership
- Authorized audit users
- Technical administrators

Each user should only see the information and actions relevant to their role.

4. MVP Scope

The first release should include:

- Requisition registration and recruiter assignment
- Candidate profiles and job applications
- CV and document storage
- Candidate source tracking
- Duplicate-candidate warnings
- Recruitment-stage tracking
- Interview scheduling
- Digital interview feedback
- Paper-assessment result recording

- Candidate-message drafting
- Recruiter approval before sending
- Email and WhatsApp support
- Tasks, reminders, and overdue alerts
- Approval-status tracking
- Selection and rejection communication
- Basic joining checklist
- Role-based dashboards
- Audit history and permissions

The first release should exclude:

- Salary details and negotiation
 - Payroll integration
 - Full onboarding
 - Candidate self-service portal
 - Automatic hiring decisions
 - Automatic rejection
 - Unapproved automatic messaging
 - Advanced psychometric testing
 - Background-verification integrations
-

5. Core Recruitment Workflow

The recommended candidate pipeline is:

New → Screening → Assessment → Interview → Feedback Pending → Approval → Selected → Joining → Joined

Alternative outcomes may include:

- On Hold
- Rejected
- Withdrawn
- Redirected
- Closed

Every active application must display:

- Current stage
- Assigned recruiter

- Next action
- Action owner
- Due date

Every stage change must create a permanent history record.

6. Key Functional Requirements

Requisitions

The system should record:

- Business unit
- Department
- Position
- Vacancy count
- Position level
- Hiring manager
- Assigned recruiter
- Target joining date
- Approval status
- ERF/RRF attachment

Suggested statuses:

Draft → Awaiting Approval → Approved → Open → On Hold → Filled → Closed

Candidate Management

Candidates may be added through manual entry, CV upload, spreadsheet import, job portals, referrals, internal pools, recruitment events, or headhunters.

Minimum details:

- Name
- Mobile number
- Email
- CV
- Candidate source
- Position applied for
- Assigned recruiter

The system should separate the candidate profile from the job application, as one candidate may apply for multiple positions.

Screening and Assessment

Recruiters should be able to record:

- Eligibility
- Screening comments
- Telephone-assessment outcome
- Availability
- Recommendation
- Assessment type
- Assessment score
- Attendance
- Uploaded assessment documents
- Evaluator recommendation

Interview Scheduling

The system should support:

- Multiple interview rounds
- Date, time, duration, location, or online link
- Interview-panel assignment
- Evaluation-form assignment
- Candidate instructions
- Interview reminders
- Rescheduling history

Candidate-facing messages must be approved by the recruiter before sending.

Interview Evaluation

Evaluation forms should be configurable for different role types.

Typical criteria may include:

- Relevant experience
- Technical or functional capability
- Communication
- Problem-solving
- Leadership

- Organizational suitability
- Strengths
- Concerns
- Overall recommendation

Panel members should not see another interviewer's evaluation until submitting their own.

Decisions and Approvals

Recruiters should see:

- Panel recommendations
- Average score
- Missing feedback
- Assessment results
- Key concerns
- Hiring-manager recommendation

The system may summarize information but must not make the final hiring decision.

Approval flows should be configurable by position, department, business unit, and authority level.

Communication

The system should support:

- Interview invitations
- Interview reminders
- Rescheduling
- Document requests
- Selection
- Rejection
- Joining reminders

Suggested workflow:

Drafted → Awaiting Approval → Approved → Sent → Delivered or Failed

Internal notes and rejection reasons must never appear automatically in candidate messages.

Joining Coordination

A simple checklist should cover:

- Candidate acceptance
- Required documents
- Reference check
- Offer letter
- Joining date
- IT request
- Workspace
- ID card
- Transport
- Induction
- Department notification
- Joining completion
- Departmental handover

Each item should have an owner, due date, status, and optional evidence.

7. User Experience Expectations

Recommended navigation:

1. Home
2. My Tasks
3. Requisitions
4. Candidates
5. Interviews
6. Messages
7. Joining
8. Reports
9. Administration

The candidate workspace should clearly display:

- Candidate name
- Position
- Current stage
- Assigned recruiter
- Next action
- Due date

The system should be:

- Responsive on desktop and mobile
 - Simple and easy to understand
 - Low in mandatory data entry
 - Consistent in buttons and status labels
 - Able to save drafts automatically
 - Accessible through readable text and high contrast
 - Designed so frequent actions require only a few steps
-

8. Dashboard Requirements

Recruiter Dashboard

- Active requisitions
- Assigned candidates
- Interviews today
- Messages awaiting approval
- Feedback overdue
- Candidate follow-ups
- Joining actions
- Overdue tasks

Talent Acquisition Head Dashboard

- Open requisitions
- Recruiter workload
- Candidates by stage
- Stage ageing
- Feedback delays
- Pending approvals
- Upcoming joining
- High-risk vacancies

Department-Head Dashboard

- Candidates awaiting review
- Upcoming interviews
- Feedback pending
- Decisions required

- Open departmental positions
-

9. Technical Expectations

The recommended architecture is a:

Modular monolith with an API-first design

The solution should include:

- Responsive web application
- Role-based navigation
- Versioned API
- Server-side authorization
- Relational database
- Secure file storage
- Background jobs
- Task and reminder engine
- Communication service
- Audit service
- Reporting capability
- Email, WhatsApp, and calendar integration layer

Modules should remain clearly separated so they may later be extracted if required.

10. Security Requirements

The proposed solution should address:

- Role-based access
- Least-privilege permissions
- Secure authentication
- Server-side authorization
- Encryption in transit and at rest
- Secure document storage
- Session controls
- Audit logging
- Controlled exports

- Restricted bulk downloads
- Field-level visibility
- Data-retention rules
- Candidate deletion or anonymization
- Protection of production data in testing environments

Technical administrators should not automatically receive access to confidential candidate information.

11. Required Demonstration Scenarios

Your submission should demonstrate:

Scenario 1: Requisition to Candidate

- Register an approved requisition
- Assign a recruiter
- Add a candidate and CV
- Display the candidate on the recruiter dashboard

Scenario 2: Interview Scheduling

- Schedule an interview
- Prepare email and WhatsApp messages
- Approve the message
- Notify the panel
- Record the communication

Scenario 3: Interview Feedback

- Send evaluation requests
- Collect individual feedback
- Identify missing evaluations
- Send overdue reminders
- Show consolidated results

Scenario 4: Candidate Decision

- Mark a candidate selected or rejected
- Prepare the relevant message
- Approve and send it
- Record the communication

Scenario 5: Joining Coordination

- Assign joining tasks
- Update checklist items
- Show readiness for joining

Scenario 6: Management Visibility

- Show recruitment bottlenecks, workload, interviews, overdue activities, and upcoming joining
 - Restrict department heads to relevant candidates
-

12. Required Submission

Please provide:

Product Interpretation

- Your understanding of the problem
- Proposed MVP
- Key assumptions
- Features intentionally excluded
- Recommended improvements

User Experience Design

Provide wireframes or prototypes for:

- Recruiter dashboard
- Requisition workspace
- Candidate pipeline
- Candidate workspace
- Interview scheduling
- Interview evaluation
- Message approval
- Joining checklist
- Management dashboard

Technical Design

Provide:

- Architecture diagram

- Module structure
- Data model
- API approach
- Authentication and authorization design
- Document-storage design
- Reminder and background-job approach
- Integration approach
- Deployment recommendation
- Security considerations

Working Prototype

Where relevant to the role, submit a working prototype demonstrating the major workflows.

Implementation Plan

Provide the recommended development sequence, key dependencies, technical risks, and adoption risks.

AI Tool Disclosure

You may use AI-assisted development tools. Briefly explain:

- Which tools you used
 - How you used them
 - Which decisions were made by you
 - How generated outputs were reviewed
-

13. Evaluation Criteria

Submissions will be assessed on:

- Business understanding
- Product judgment
- Simplicity and usability
- Technical architecture
- Security and data design
- Engineering quality
- Practical implementation
- Clarity of communication
- Ownership of decisions

A strong submission will not simply reproduce the requirements. It will demonstrate thoughtful prioritization and a practical understanding of how the system would be adopted within Anwar Group.

Final Note

Approach this assignment as though you are joining Anwar Group and will remain responsible for improving the product after launch.

We are interested in how you understand the problem, simplify the process, make decisions, and build a solution that employees would genuinely use.